

AWS COMMUNITY DAY GHANA 2026

Event Action & Planning Document

Date: Saturday, 29 August 2026

Location: Accra, Ghana

Organised by AWS User Group Accra

1. Executive Summary

AWS Community Day Ghana 2026 is a one-day technology conference convened by the AWS User Group Accra. The event brings together cloud practitioners, developers, students, founders, and industry leaders for a day of learning, networking, and showcasing how Amazon Web Services is being applied to solve African problems across EdTech, FinTech, AgriTech, and other sectors.

This document outlines the full action plan covering venue selection, budget, sponsorship packaging, speakers, volunteers, food and beverage, decor, media, and operational logistics. The plan is designed around a target attendance of 300 in-person participants, with AWS providing a seed grant of approximately GH¢34,800 (USD 3,000 at GH¢11.60 per USD). The remaining funding will be raised through structured sponsorship packages from local and international partners.

Key Event Details

Item	Detail
Event Name	AWS Community Day Ghana 2026
Date	Saturday, 29 August 2026
Expected Attendance	300 participants (in-person)
Format	Keynotes, panels, breakout sessions, hands-on workshops, networking
Organiser	AWS User Group Accra
Seed Funding	USD 3,000 from AWS (approx. GH¢34,800)
Estimated Total Budget	GH¢95,150 (recommended venue option)
Funding Gap to Raise	GH¢60,350 via sponsorships
Contact	awsaccrausergroup@gmail.com

2. Event Objectives

The community day is built around five measurable objectives:

1. Convene at least 300 participants from across Ghana's technology ecosystem in a single venue.
2. Deliver a minimum of 12 sessions spanning keynote, panel, breakout, and workshop formats.
3. Spotlight at least three vertical applications of AWS in Africa, including EdTech, FinTech, and AgriTech.
4. Onboard at least 50 new members to the AWS User Group Accra community.

3. Venue Selection

Two venue options have been evaluated. Both are suitable, but they differ significantly in cost and capacity. The recommendation is provided after the comparison.

3.1 Venue Comparison

Criteria	Option A: Cedi Conference Centre	Option B: Main Auditorium (alternative venue)
Space Type	Auditorium	Main Auditorium
Capacity	850 seats	300 participants
Day Rate	GH¢30,000	GH¢6,500 + 1,800+ 2,200 + 1,500
Wi-Fi Cost	GH¢3,000 (10% of room rate)	Included (assumed)
Features Included	Large auditorium, foyer and lawn available as add-ons	Conference chairs, executive chairs, air conditioning, LED screen, public address system, standby generator, pagodas for refreshments
Total Venue Cost	GH¢33,000	GH¢12,000

3.2 Recommendation

Option B is the recommended venue. The 300-seat capacity matches the target attendance, the day rate is significantly lower at GH¢6,500 versus GH¢33,000 for the larger venue, and the included amenities (LED screen, public address system, air conditioning, and a standby generator) reduce the need for separate equipment hire. The savings of approximately GH¢26,500 can be redirected to better speaker support, marketing, and attendee experience.

Option A should be reconsidered only if registrations exceed 500 participants or if a major co-headline sponsor commits to underwriting the larger venue cost.

4. Detailed Budget

All amounts are in Ghana Cedis. The food and beverage figures reflect the pricing structure provided by the organising team.

4.1 Food and Beverage Breakdown

Item	Unit Price (GH¢)	Quantity	Subtotal (GH¢)	Notes
Jollof Rice	60	200	12,000	Lunch service
Waakye	65	200	13,000	Lunch service
Fried yam	50	100	5,000	Lunch alternative
Subtotal		500 servings	30,000	
Vendor Discount			(2,000)	No delivery, self pickup
Food Total			28,000	

4.2 Full Budget Summary

Category	Amount (GH¢)	Notes
Venue (Option B recommended)	12,000	Main Auditorium, full day
Food (Jollof, Waakye, Fried Yam)	28,000	After GH¢2,000 vendor discount
Water, light snacks, drinks	15,000	Coffee, tea, mineral water, biscuits, fruit
Decor	7,000	Stage backdrop, signage, branded elements
Media coverage	10,000	Photography, videography, livestream
Speaker logistics	8,000	Local transport, modest gifts, hotel for out-of-town speakers
Swag and attendee kits	12,000	T-shirts, stickers, lanyards, badges
Volunteer support (meals, T-shirts)	3,000	Approximately 25 volunteers
Printing and stationery	2,000	Programmes, name tags, signage prints
Contingency (approx. 10%)	8,650	Buffer for unexpected costs

TOTAL ESTIMATED BUDGET	100,150	
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4.3 Funding Position

Source	Amount (USD)	Amount (GH¢)
AWS Seed Grant	3,000	34,800
Total Budget Required		105,650
Funding Gap to Close via Sponsorship		70,850

Exchange rate used: USD 1 = GH¢11.60 (as of 24 May 2026, mid-market rate). The exact value of the AWS grant in cedis will depend on the rate at the time of conversion.

5. Sponsorship Packages

Sponsorship is the primary mechanism for closing the funding gap of approximately GH¢65,350. Five tiers are proposed, with realistic price points calibrated to the Ghanaian corporate market. A successful run of the campaign would mean securing at least one Platinum, two Gold, three Silver, and four Bronze sponsors, which together raise approximately GH¢135,000 and leave headroom for a stretch goal.

5.1 Sponsorship Tiers

Tier	Price (GH¢)	Benefits	Target Sponsors
Platinum	50,000	Headline sponsor billing. 15-minute keynote slot. Premium booth (3m x 3m). Logo lockup on stage backdrop, T-shirts, website, and all marketing. 12 VIP tickets. Dedicated social media announcement. Branded segment in livestream. Inclusion in post-event report.	Major banks, telcos, large fintechs
Gold	25,000	Panel sponsorship rights for one track. Standard booth (2m x 2m). Logo on backdrop, T-shirts, and website. 8 tickets. Two social media posts. Inclusion in post-event report.	Mid-size tech firms, scale-ups
Silver	12,000	Logo on website, programme, and T-shirts. Shared booth space. 5 tickets. One social media post. Branded item in attendee swag bag.	SMEs, growing startups
Bronze	5,000	Logo on website and programme. 3 tickets. Group social media mention.	Startups, agencies
Community Partner	2,000	Logo on website. 2 tickets. Group thank-you on social media. Open to non-profits, communities, and bootcamps.	Hubs, schools, communities

5.2 In-Kind Sponsorship

In-kind support is welcomed and valued at the equivalent cash tier. Examples include:

- Catering or beverage supply (equivalent to Silver or Gold depending on coverage).
- Swag production such as T-shirts, lanyards, or notebooks.
- Photography and videography services.
- Cloud credits or technical workshop sponsorship.
- Ride-share vouchers for speakers and volunteers.

5.3 Sponsorship Targets

Tier	Target Count	Revenue (GH¢)	Status
Platinum	1	50,000	To be confirmed
Gold	2	50,000	To be confirmed
Silver	3	36,000	To be confirmed
Bronze	4	20,000	To be confirmed
Community Partner	5	10,000	To be confirmed
Target Sponsorship Revenue	15	166,000	

Even if only 50% of these targets are met, the resulting GH¢83,000 would fully close the funding gap. Excess funds will be reinvested into community programming through the rest of 2026.

6. Speakers and Programme

The speaker line-up is structured across three formats: keynotes, panels, and breakout sessions. Each format is designed to balance high-level inspiration with practical, hands-on learning.

6.1 Programme at a Glance

Time	Session	Format
08:00 - 09:00	Arrival, registration, breakfast snacks	Networking
09:00 - 09:30	Opening remarks and welcome	MC + User Group Lead
09:30 - 10:15	Opening Keynote: The State of Cloud in Africa	Keynote
10:15 - 11:00	Keynote 2: Building for Scale on AWS	Keynote
11:00 - 11:15	Coffee break	Break
11:15 - 12:15	Panel: African Builders on Generative AI	Panel (4 speakers + moderator)
12:15 - 13:15	Lunch	Networking
13:15 - 14:00	Track 1: FinTech on AWS - Hubtel Track 2: EdTech on AWS - ITC Track 3: AgriTech on AWS	Breakout - Session 1 (45 mins)
14:00 - 14:45	Track 1: FinTech on AWS - Track 2: EdTech on AWS - Track 3: AgriTech on AWS	Breakout - session 2 (40 mins)
14:45 - 15:30	Breakout sessions based on speakers who applied	Breakout - (session 3 40mins)
15:30 - 15:45	Tea break	Break
15:45 - 16:30	Fireside chat: Cloud Careers and Community Building	Panel (4 speakers + moderator)
16:30 - 17:00	Closing ceremony, raffle, group photo	Closing
17:00 onwards	Networking reception	Networking

Cloud Horror Stories: Mistakes and Anti-Patterns Not to be Repeated

6.2 Proposed Speaker Roles

Keynote Speakers (2 slots)

- One AWS Hero, AWS Senior Developer Advocate, or AWS staff from EMEA or the Sub-Saharan Africa team.
- One senior technology leader from a recognised Ghanaian or pan-African company (CTO, VP Engineering, or Head of Cloud).

Panel: African Builders on Generative AI

- Moderator: AWS Community Builder or User Group Lead.
- 4 panelists drawn from: a generative AI startup founder, an enterprise ML lead, an academic researcher, and a product manager applying GenAI in a regulated industry.

Breakout Session 1 & 2

Breakout Track 1: FinTech on AWS

- Speaker 1: Senior engineer from a Ghanaian fintech (payments, lending, or mobile money).
- Speaker 2: Architect speaking on PCI DSS and compliance patterns on AWS. - David Quarguine

Breakout Track 2: EdTech on AWS

- Speaker 1: Founder or CTO of a Ghanaian or African EdTech platform. - Ebow Anamuah
- Speaker 2: Practitioner sharing a serverless architecture pattern for learning platforms.

Breakout Track 3: AgriTech on AWS

- Speaker 1: Founder or engineer from an AgriTech startup using IoT, satellite data, or analytics.
- Speaker 2: Data engineer covering data pipelines on AWS for agricultural use cases.

Breakout Session 3 - Speakers from the community

Panel: Cloud Careers and Community Building

- Moderator: AWS Community Builder.
- 4 panelists: an AWS-certified professional who transitioned mid-career, a recruiter or talent lead, a recent graduate now working in cloud, and a community organiser.

6.3 Speaker Outreach Plan

5. Compile a long list of 25 to 30 candidate speakers across all tracks by 15 June 2026.
6. Send personalised invitations with a one-page event brief by 22 June 2026.
7. Confirm all keynote and panel speakers by 15 July 2026.
8. Collect speaker bios, headshots, and session abstracts by 31 July 2026.
9. Send logistical confirmation (transport, parking, run-of-show) by 20 August 2026.
10. Host a virtual speaker briefing on 25 August 2026.

7. Volunteers

The event will be supported by approximately 25 volunteers organised into role-based teams. Volunteers receive a branded T-shirt, all meals on the day, a certificate of participation, and priority access to future community activities.

7.1 Volunteer Teams and Counts

Team	Count	Responsibilities
Registration	4	Check-in attendees, distribute badges and swag, manage walk-ins.
Logistics and Floor	5	Direct attendees, manage signage, coordinate between rooms and the registration desk.
Speaker Care	3	Receive speakers on arrival, escort them to the green room, prepare slide handovers, manage timing on stage.
Technical AV	3	Operate microphones, slide clickers, livestream feed, and Wi-Fi support.
Social Media	3	Live coverage on LinkedIn and X, capture quotes and clips, monitor the event hashtag.
Photography Support	2	Assist the lead photographer, coordinate group photos, manage props.
Food and Beverage	3	Coordinate with the caterer, manage the buffet flow, monitor water and snack stations.
Sponsor Liaison	2	Set up booths in the morning, check in with sponsors hourly, support tear-down.

7.2 Volunteer Timeline

11. Open volunteer applications on 20 June 2026.
12. Close applications on 18 July 2026.
13. Shortlist and confirm volunteers by 25 July 2026.
14. Hold a virtual orientation on 10 August 2026.
15. Hold an in-person briefing and venue walk-through on 28 August 2026.

8. Food, Decor, and Attendee Experience

8.1 Food and Beverage Plan

The lunch service centres on three crowd-friendly Ghanaian options. Jollof rice and waakye are served from 12:15 to 13:15, with fried yam as a lighter alternative. Vegetarian portions will be reserved during procurement. Self-pickup from the vendor (in place of delivery) secures a GH¢2,000 discount, bringing total food spend to GH¢28,000. A separate refreshment budget of GH¢15,000 covers bottled water, soft drinks, tea, coffee, biscuits, and fresh fruit available throughout the day.

8.2 Decor Plan

The GH¢7,000 decor budget covers the stage backdrop with AWS Community Day Ghana branding, sponsor logo wall, table centrepieces in AWS orange and navy, directional signage in the foyer, photo wall for attendee selfies, and a welcome arch at the venue entrance. Local craft elements such as kente accents will be incorporated where appropriate to celebrate the Ghanaian setting.

8.3 Media and Coverage

The GH¢10,000 media budget covers a lead photographer for the full day, a videographer producing a 2 to 3 minute highlight reel, a basic livestream of the main stage, and a content editor delivering social media clips within 72 hours of the event. Raw footage will be archived for use by sponsors and AWS reporting.

9. Master Timeline

Date	Milestone
1 June 2026	Finalise venue contract (Option B). Lock in AWS grant disbursement.
5 June 2026	Launch sponsorship outreach campaign.
15 June 2026	Complete speaker long list. Open registration site.
20 June 2026	Open volunteer applications.
22 June 2026	Send speaker invitations.
15 July 2026	Confirm all keynote and panel speakers. Confirm Platinum and Gold sponsors.
18 July 2026	Close volunteer applications.
25 July 2026	Confirm volunteers. Confirm Silver and Bronze sponsors.
31 July 2026	Collect speaker bios, headshots, and abstracts. Begin printing.
10 August 2026	Virtual volunteer orientation. Marketing push begins.
20 August 2026	Send speaker logistical confirmation. Final sponsor logos lodged.
25 August 2026	Virtual speaker briefing. Final caterer confirmation.
28 August 2026	In-person volunteer briefing and venue walk-through. Decor setup begins.
29 August 2026	EVENT DAY.
5 September 2026	Post-event thank-you communications. Sponsor reports issued.
15 September 2026	Final financial reconciliation. Lessons-learned debrief.

10. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Owner Responsibilities
Event Lead	Owns overall execution, signs off on budget, primary liaison with AWS and Platinum sponsor.
Programme Lead	Curates speakers, finalises agenda, runs speaker briefings.
Sponsorship Lead	Drives sponsor outreach, manages contracts and deliverables, owns sponsor satisfaction.
Operations Lead	Owns venue, food, decor, equipment, and day-of logistics.
Volunteer Coordinator	Recruits, briefs, and manages all volunteers across teams.
Marketing Lead	Owns brand, social media, registration funnel, and post-event communications.
Finance Lead	Manages bank account, tracks all transactions, produces final reconciliation report.

11. Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Sponsorship targets not met	Medium	High	Begin outreach early. Approach 40+ companies. Have a scaled-down event plan ready.
Lower attendance than expected	Medium	Medium	Run paid social ads. Partner with universities and bootcamps for group registrations.
Key speaker cancellation	Medium	Medium	Maintain a backup speaker list for every track. Confirm 2 weeks before the event.
Venue Wi-Fi failure during livestream	Low	High	Carry a 4G or 5G mobile router as backup. Test livestream in venue 24 hours prior.
Power outage	Low	High	Venue includes a standby generator. Charge laptops, batteries, and projectors in advance.
Food shortage if attendance exceeds 500	Low	Medium	Cap registration at 350. Maintain caterer hotline for emergency top-up order.
Currency depreciation reducing AWS grant value	Medium	Low	Convert the USD grant to GH¢ as soon as it lands. Hold the cedi balance.

12. Volunteer Sign-Up Form (Template)

The following template can be copied directly into Google Forms, Typeform, or any similar tool. Fields marked with an asterisk are required.

Section A: Personal Information

1. Full name *

Short answer text

2. Email address *

Short answer text, email validation

3. Phone number (WhatsApp preferred) *

Short answer text

4. City and region of residence *

Short answer text

5. LinkedIn or X (Twitter) handle (optional)

Short answer text

Section B: Background

6. Current role or status *

- Student
- Working professional
- Founder or entrepreneur
- Educator
- Between roles
- Other (please specify)

7. AWS experience level *

- New to AWS
- Familiar but not certified
- AWS Certified
- AWS Community Builder or Hero

8. Have you volunteered for a tech community event before? *

- Yes
- No

9. If yes, briefly describe your most recent volunteer experience.

Long answer text (optional)

Section C: Volunteer Preferences

10. Which team would you most like to join? (Choose up to 2) *

- Registration
- Logistics and floor management
- Speaker care
- Technical AV
- Social media
- Photography support
- Food and beverage
- Sponsor liaison

11. What languages do you speak fluently? *

- English
- Twi
- Ga
- Ewe
- French
- Other (please specify)

12. Why do you want to volunteer at AWS Community Day Ghana 2026? *

Long answer text (50 to 200 words)

Section D: Logistics

13. Are you available for the in-person briefing on Friday, 28 August 2026? *

- Yes
- No
- Maybe, will confirm closer to the date

14. Are you available the full day on Saturday, 29 August 2026 from 07:00 to 19:00? *

- Yes, fully available
- Available for half the day only (please specify which half)

15. T-shirt size *

- S
- M
- L
- XL
- XXL

16. Do you have any dietary restrictions or allergies? *

Short answer text

17. Emergency contact name and phone number *

Short answer text

Section E: Consent

18. I understand that volunteers serve in a non-paid capacity and agree to the volunteer code of conduct. *

- Yes, I agree

19. I consent to my photo being taken during the event and used in AWS User Group Accra communications. *

- Yes
- No

20. How did you hear about this opportunity?

- LinkedIn
- X (Twitter)
- WhatsApp community
- University or bootcamp
- Referral from a friend
- Other

*Form responses will feed into a master volunteer tracker maintained by the Volunteer Coordinator.
Shortlisted applicants will receive a confirmation email by 25 July 2026.*

13. Approval

This action document represents the working plan for AWS Community Day Ghana 2026. Once approved by the AWS User Group Accra leadership team, it becomes the reference point for all subsequent operational decisions. Material changes to budget, venue, or programme should be logged and circulated to the leadership team within 48 hours.

Event Lead	Signature	Date
AWS User Group Accra Lead	Signature	Date
Finance Lead	Signature	Date